

Hands-on Workshop on Research Work

Selecting research issue and framing research title

Bijay Lal Pradhan

Tribhuvan University

02/10/2026

Presentation Outline

Course Objectives

Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills

From Research Idea to Research Proposal

Course Objectives

Course Objectives

The objective of this course is to develop knowledge and skills on:

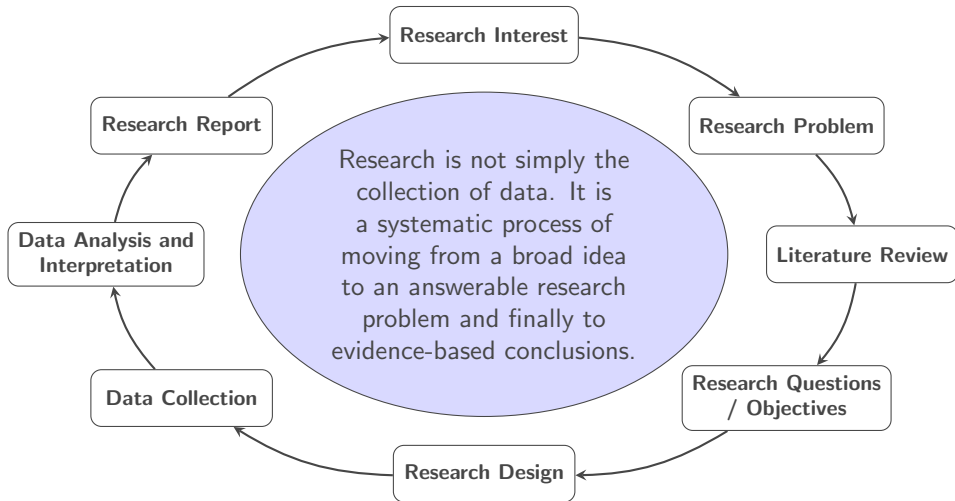
- ▶ Designing and writing an academic research proposal.
- ▶ Selecting appropriate research methods and designs.
- ▶ Collecting and analyzing research data.
- ▶ Conducting academic research systematically.
- ▶ Writing and presenting a scientific research report.

Major Components of Research

1. Develop Research Idea
2. Writing of Research Proposal
3. Conducting Academic Research
4. Analysis and Interpretation of Data
5. Scientific Report Writing

Research Idea → Proposal → Research → Report

The Complete Research Journey



Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills

Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills

1. Academic Literature Search

[Google Scholar](#), [Semantic Scholar](#), academic databases, Boolean search, and citation searching.

2. Reference Management

[Zotero](#)/ [Mendeley](#), citation management, bibliography generation, and reference organization. [Endnote](#) is another one can be download from [mywebsite](#).

3. Digital Literature Review

Literature matrix, [ResearchRabbit](#), [Connected Papers](#), and research gap identification.

4. Digital Research Writing

[Microsoft Word](#), [Overleaf](#)/LaTeX, collaborative writing, formatting, and document management.

Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills (Continued)

5. Digital Data Collection

[Google Forms](#), [KoboToolbox](#), survey design, data validation, and digital data management.

6. Data Analysis Software

[Excel](#)/ [SPSS](#)/ [R](#) for quantitative analysis and [Tagut](#)/[NVivo](#)/ [ATLAS.ti](#)/ [MAXQDA](#) for qualitative analysis. There are many freeware software like [JASP](#), [Jamovi](#), [gretl](#) etc.

7. AI-Assisted Research

[Elicit](#) [Review Matrix, Metadata], [Consensus](#) [Review writing], [NotebookLM](#), [SciSpace](#),. Literature discovery, evidence synthesis, research paper analysis, citation verification, document-based research.

8. Research Project Management

[Notion](#) [Trello](#) [Task Management]; [Google Drive](#) [Cloud Storage, File Organization, Collaboration].

From a Broad Topic to a Research Problem

Broad Area

Digital Public Service Delivery



Specific Topic

Digital Public Service Delivery in Local Governments



Research Problem

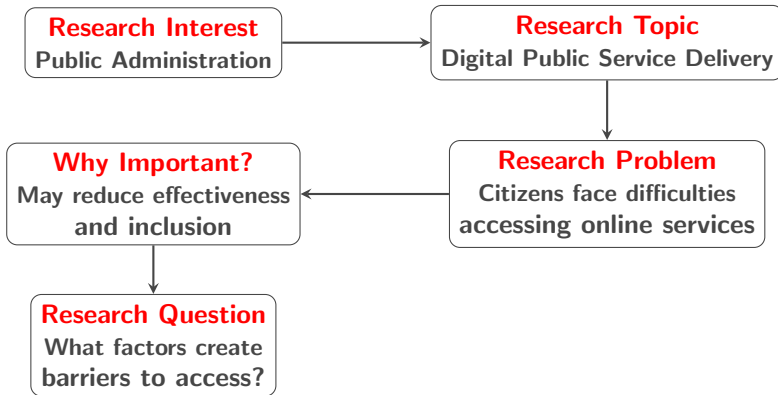
Despite the expansion of digital public services, citizens may still face barriers related to access, digital literacy, infrastructure, and institutional capacity.



Research Question

What factors affect the effective delivery and utilization of digital public services?

From Research Interest to Research Problem: Example



From Research Idea to Research Proposal

From Knowing Research Tools to Doing Research

Research Productivity Tools



Finding a Research Interest



Identifying a Real-World Problem



Developing a Research Topic



Finding Research Evidence

Activity I: Identify Your Research Interest

Ask yourself:

1. What subject or issue interests you the most?
2. Which area of Public Administration would you like to study?
3. Do you prefer studying **people, organizations, policies, institutions, or data**?
4. What problems have you observed in government or public service delivery?
5. Is there any issue that you would like to understand, explain, or improve?

Your Task

Write down **one broad area of research interest**.

Possible Research Interest Areas in Public Administration

- ▶ Public Policy
- ▶ Local Governance
- ▶ Public Service Delivery
- ▶ E-Governance
- ▶ Public Financial Management
- ▶ Public Sector Human Resource Management
- ▶ Development Administration
- ▶ Good Governance
- ▶ Citizen Participation
- ▶ Administrative Reform
- ▶ Public Accountability
- ▶ Digital Government
- ▶ Disaster Governance
- ▶ Gender and Social Inclusion

Remember

Your research interest is only the **starting point**. It is not yet a research problem.

From Interest to Research Topic

Interest Area

What I am interested in studying

+

Real-World Problem

What is happening or what needs to be understood or improved?

⇓

Research Topic

What my research will investigate, explain, or understand

Example: From Interest to Research Topic

Interest Area

Digital Public Service Delivery



Observed Problem

Citizens face difficulties accessing and using online public services.



Possible Research Topic

Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services among Citizens

Possible Research Question

What factors create barriers to accessing digital public services?

Activity II: Identify a Real-World Problem

Think about your experience, workplace, community, or public institution.

Ask yourself:

- ▶ What problem have I observed?
- ▶ Who is affected by this problem?
- ▶ Why might this problem exist?
- ▶ Why is this problem important?
- ▶ Can this problem be investigated through research?

Your Task

Write one **real-world problem** related to your interest area.

From Interest and Problem to Research Topic

Interest Area	Observed Problem	Possible Research Topic
Digital Government	Citizens face difficulties accessing online services	Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services
Local Governance	Limited citizen participation in local decision-making	Factors Affecting Citizen Participation in Local Governance
Public Service Delivery	Long waiting times and inefficient services	Factors Affecting Efficiency in Public Service Delivery
Public Accountability	Limited transparency in public institutions	Public Accountability and Transparency in Local Government

From Research Topic to Keywords

Example Research Topic

Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services among Citizens

1. **Core Concepts**

Digital public services; access barriers

2. **Context**

Citizens; local government; Nepal

3. **Synonyms**

E-government; digital government; online public services

Possible Keywords

Digital government; e-government; online public services; access barriers; digital inclusion; citizens

Searching for Research Literature

Example Search String

"digital public services" AND "access barriers"

Alternative Search

("e-government" OR "digital government")
AND
("digital inclusion" OR "service access")
AND Nepal

- ▶ **AND** — includes both concepts
- ▶ **OR** — includes alternative terms
- ▶ **" "** — searches an exact phrase
- ▶ ***** — searches word variations

Practical Activity: Literature Search

Search your research topic using Google Scholar.

For each article, check:

1. Title
2. Author and year
3. Abstract
4. Research context
5. Methodology
6. Key findings
7. Citation count
8. Relevance to your research topic

Important

Do not simply collect papers. Read the abstract and evaluate whether the article is relevant to your research.

Organizing the Literature: Review Matrix

Author & Year	Study Focus	Method	Key Findings	Research Gap
Study 1				
Study 2				
Study 3				
Study 4				

Purpose

The review matrix helps you organize research evidence, compare studies, and identify possible research gaps.

From Literature Review to Research Gap

What do previous studies already tell us?
What is missing, limited, unclear, or unexplored?

Research Gap

The specific area where additional research is needed.

Examples:

- ▶ Limited evidence in a particular context
- ▶ Limited geographical or population coverage
- ▶ Methodological limitations
- ▶ Inconsistent research findings
- ▶ Important variables have been ignored

From Research Gap to Research Question

Research Problem

Citizens experience difficulties accessing digital public services.



Research Gap

Limited evidence exists regarding the specific barriers experienced by citizens in the selected context.



Research Question

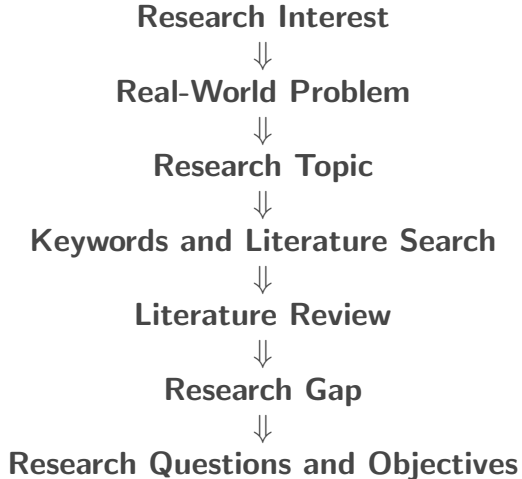
What factors create barriers to citizens' access to digital public services?



Research Objective

To identify and examine the factors creating barriers to citizens' access to digital public services.

The Complete Research Journey



Your Semester II Research Journey

1. Research Interest
2. Research Problem
3. Research Topic
4. Literature Review and Research Gap
5. Research Questions and Objectives
6. Research Design and Methodology
7. Sampling and Data Collection
8. Data Analysis and Interpretation
9. Research Proposal
10. Research Report

Our Goal

By the end of this semester, you should be able to transform a research idea into a systematic research proposal and report.

Assignment for the Next Class

1. Identify **one research interest area**.
2. Identify **one real-world problem** related to that area.
3. Develop a preliminary **research topic**.
4. Extract at least **five keywords**.
5. Search for at least **five relevant research articles**.
6. Prepare a simple **literature review matrix**.
7. Identify one possible **research gap**.

Bring Your Work to the Next Class

Your preliminary work will be used to develop your **research problem, research questions, and objectives**.

Key Takeaway

Good research begins with a clear problem and ends with evidence-based conclusions.

Interest → Problem → Question → Evidence → Knowledge

Remember

A well-defined research problem is the foundation of a successful research study.

Thank You

Questions and Discussion

From curiosity to evidence, research is a journey of systematic inquiry.